

# Oborcopy User Guide

**Back up and mirror your folders – safely and step by step**

Version 1.1.0 · for Windows 10/11 and Linux

# Contents


1. What is Oborcopy?
2. Installation
3. Quick start – your first backup in 6 steps
4. The main window
5. Managing jobs
6. Step by step: running a sync
7. Reading the results
8. Advanced options
9. Weekly backups – the recommended routine
10. Automatic backups
11. Settings, log files and where things are stored
12. How Oborcopy protects your data
13. Questions and troubleshooting
14. Keyboard shortcuts and version
15. Glossary

# 1. What is Oborcopy?

Oborcopy keeps a **copy of a folder up to date** – for example your music collection on one disk and its backup on another disk. The first run copies everything. Every later run only copies what has **changed**, so a weekly backup usually takes just seconds or minutes.

Oborcopy works with two modes:

| Mode | What it does | Typical use |
|---|---|---|
| **Update** | Copies new and changed files to the destination. **Nothing is ever deleted** in the destination. | Collecting files, "add only" backups |
| **Mirror** | Like Update, and in addition **deletes files in the destination that no longer exist in the source**. Afterwards both folders are identical. | An exact backup of your music, photos or documents |

> **Example:** You removed an album from your music collection. With **Update** the album stays on the backup disk. With **Mirror** it is also removed from the backup disk – but only after Oborcopy has shown you the list and you have confirmed it.

Words used in this guide:

- **Source** – the folder you want to back up (e.g. `D:\Music`).
- **Destination** – the folder that receives the copy (e.g. `E:\Music`).
- **Job** – a saved set of settings: source, destination, mode and options. You can save as many jobs as you like.

# 2. Installation

Oborcopy does not need an installer. You unpack it and start it.

## 2.1 Windows 10 / 11

1. Unpack `Oborcopy-1.1.0-win64.zip` to a folder of your choice, for example `C:\Tools\Oborcopy`.
2. Double-click **`Oborcopy.exe`**.
3. *Optional:* right-click `Oborcopy.exe` → **Show more options** → **Send to** → **Desktop (create shortcut)**.

> **Note:** Keep all files of the folder together – the DLL files and sub-folders are needed.
>
> If Windows shows "*Windows protected your PC*" (SmartScreen) the first time, click **More info** → **Run anyway**. This appears for programs downloaded from the internet that are not signed by a publisher.

## 2.2 Linux

Requirements: 64-bit Linux, as new as Ubuntu 24.04 or newer (e.g. Linux Mint 22, Debian 13, Fedora 40), with a normal desktop. Everything else is included.

1. Unpack the archive in a terminal:

   ```
   tar xzf oborcopy-1.1.0-linux-x86_64.tar.gz
   ```

2. Start Oborcopy:

   ```
   cd oborcopy-1.1.0-linux-x86_64
   ./oborcopy
   ```

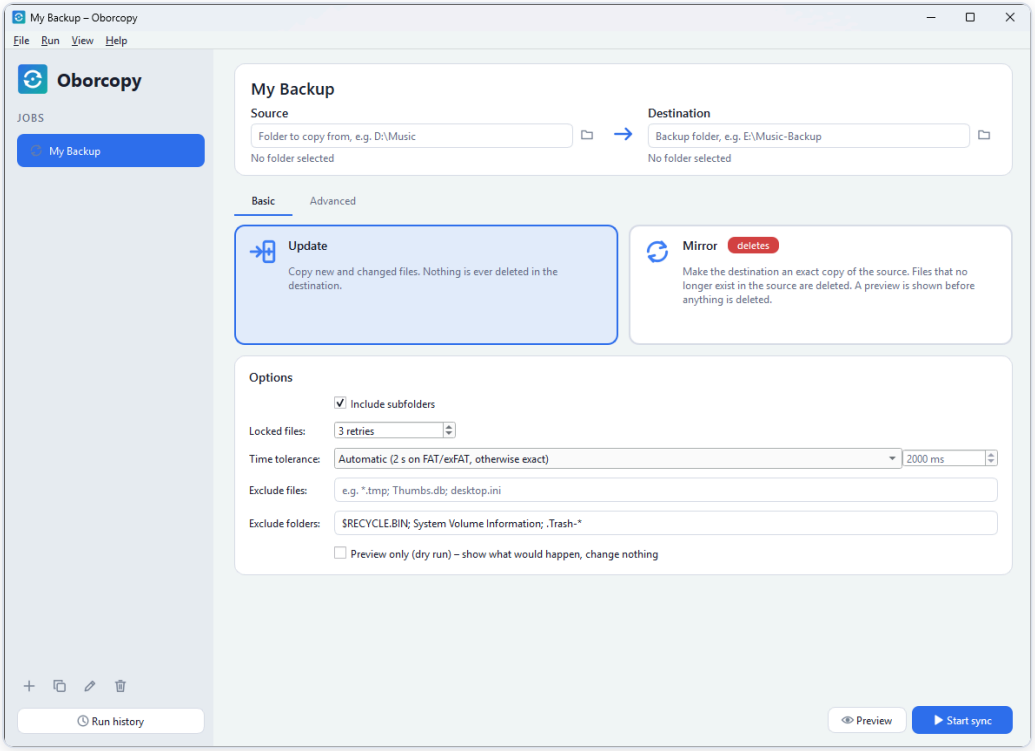
3. *Optional:* add Oborcopy to your application menu:

   ```
   ./install-desktop-entry.sh
   ```

   (Run it again if you move the folder later.)

# 3. Quick start – your first backup in 6 steps

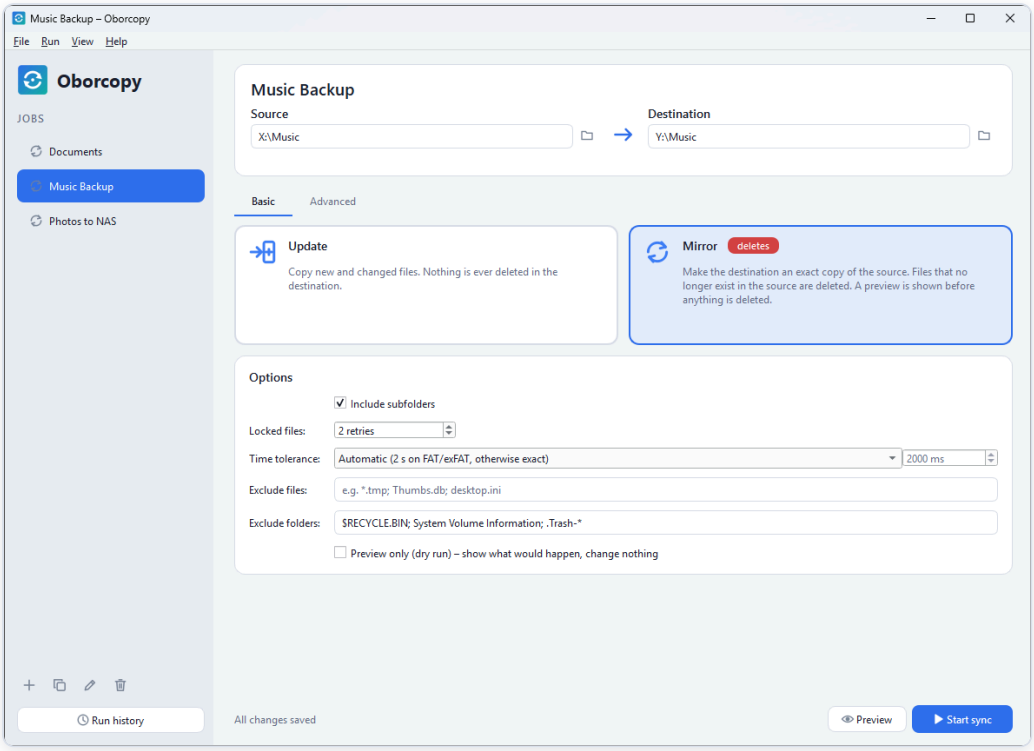
When you start Oborcopy for the first time, it creates an empty job called **My Backup**:




1. **Source:** click the folder icon next to *Source* and choose the folder you want to back up (e.g. your music folder).
2. **Destination:** click the folder icon next to *Destination* and choose the folder on your backup disk. It may be empty or not exist yet.
3. **Mode:** click the card **Update** (never deletes) or **Mirror** (exact copy).
4. **Preview:** click **Preview** at the bottom right. Oborcopy shows what it *would* do – nothing is changed yet. Close the preview.
5. **Start:** click **Start sync**. In Mirror mode you confirm the deletions once more (see section 6.3).
6. **Result:** at the end you see a summary such as "*1,204 files checked, 37 copied, 12 updated, 7 deleted, 0 errors*". Click **Show details** for the full list.

That's it. Your settings are saved automatically – next week you only click **Start sync** again.

# 4. The main window




| Area | What you find there |
|---|---|
| **Sidebar (left)** | Your jobs. Click a job to open it. The buttons below the list create **(+)**, duplicate, rename and delete jobs. **Run history** shows earlier runs. |
| **Job header (top)** | The job name, **Source** and **Destination**. Below each folder Oborcopy shows information about the disk, e.g. "*exFAT · 412 GB free of 1.8 TB · 2 s timestamps*". |
| **Basic tab** | The mode cards **Update** / **Mirror** and the most important options. Most users never need more. |
| **Advanced tab** | All further options, grouped into sections (section 8). |
| **Action bar (bottom)** | **Preview** and **Start sync**. While a sync is running: **Pause/Resume** and **Cancel**. On the left a status text, e.g. "*All changes saved*". |
| **Menu bar** | *File* (new job, save, run history, log folder, exit), *Run* (start, preview, pause, cancel), *View* (theme), *Help* (About). |

## 4.1 Choosing folders

There are three ways to enter a folder:

- click the **folder icon** and pick the folder,
- **type or paste** the path into the field, or
- **drag a folder** from Explorer / your file manager **onto the field**.

A **dot** in front of *Source* and *Destination* shows whether the folder can be reached right now. Oborcopy checks this every few seconds, so it changes as soon as you plug in or unplug a disk or a network drive goes offline:

| Dot | Meaning |
|---|---|
| green | **Online** – the folder is reachable. For the destination also: *folder does not exist yet – it will be created* (its parent folder exists). |
| red | **Offline** – the disk is not connected, the network share is not reachable or the folder was not found. |
| grey | No folder chosen yet, or the check is still running. |

**Preview** and **Start sync** (and `F5` / `F6`) are only available while both dots are green. The line at the bottom of the window tells you which folder is missing.

## 4.2 The Basic options

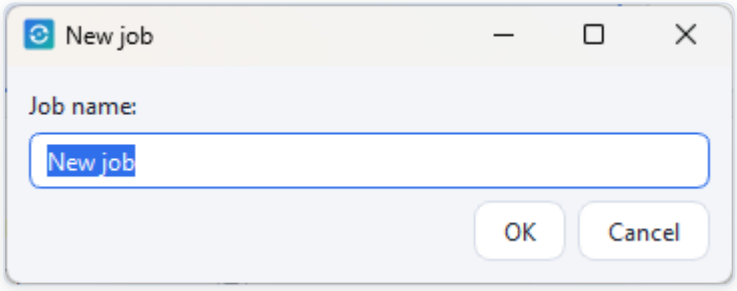
| Option | Meaning | Recommendation |
|---|---|---|
| **Include subfolders** | Also copy everything inside sub-folders. | On |
| **Locked files** | How often a file that is in use by another program is tried again. The wait grows each time (2 s, 4 s, 8 s …). | 3 retries |
| **Time tolerance** | How exact the file times must match to count as "unchanged". *Automatic* allows 2 seconds on FAT/exFAT disks (USB sticks, many external disks) – otherwise every file would look changed. | Automatic |
| **Exclude files** | Files that are skipped, separated by `;`. Wildcards: `*` = any text, `?` = one character. Example: `*.tmp; Thumbs.db; desktop.ini` | as needed |
| **Exclude folders** | Folders that are skipped. Windows system folders are excluded already. | keep the defaults |
| **Preview only (dry run)** | Every run only shows what would happen – nothing is changed. | Off |

> **Good to know:** Excluded files are neither copied nor deleted – also not in Mirror mode.

# 5. Managing jobs

A **job** stores everything about one backup task. Create one job per task, e.g. *Music Backup*, *Photos to NAS*, *Documents*.

| Action | How |
|---|---|
| **Create a job** | Click **+** below the job list (or *File* → *New job…*, `Ctrl+N`) and enter a name. |
| **Open a job** | Click it in the list. |
| **Rename** | Double-click the job, or click the pencil button. |
| **Duplicate** | Select the job and click the duplicate button – useful for a second backup disk with the same settings. |
| **Delete** | Click the trash button. Only the job settings are removed – **no files are touched**. |
| **Save** | Not needed: every change is saved automatically within a second. |

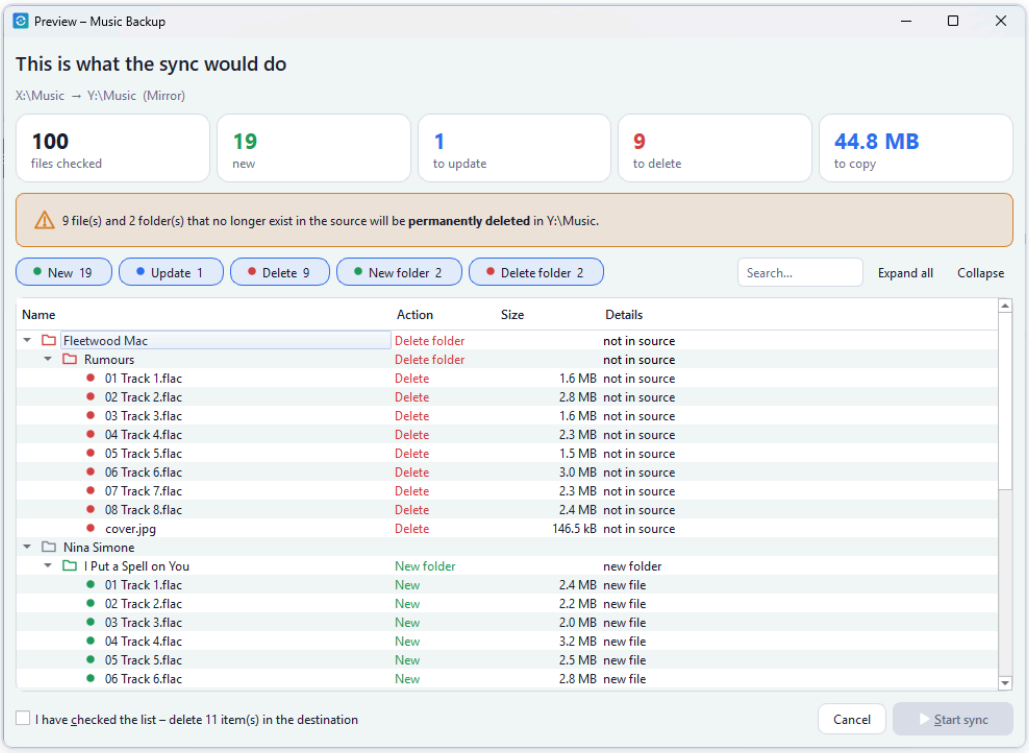


# 6. Step by step: running a sync

The following example uses the job **Music Backup** in **Mirror** mode: the music collection on `X:\Music` is mirrored to the backup disk `Y:\Music`. Since the last backup two albums were added, one track was re-ripped and one album was removed.

## 6.1 Preview – see what will happen

Click **Preview** (or press `F6`). Oborcopy scans both folders and compares them. **Nothing is changed.**




At the top you see the numbers: files checked, **new** files, files **to update**, files **to delete**, and how much data will be copied.

Below is a **folder tree** with every planned action:

- ● **New** – the file does not exist in the destination yet.
- ● **Update** – the file exists but is different (newer, older or a different size).
- ● **Delete** – the file exists only in the destination (Mirror mode only).

The coloured buttons above the tree (*New 19*, *Update 1*, *Delete 9*, …) are **filters**: click one to hide or show that kind of entry. Use **Search…** to find a file, **Expand all / Collapse** to open or close the folders.

If everything looks right you can click **Start sync** directly in the preview – or **Cancel** to go back without changes.

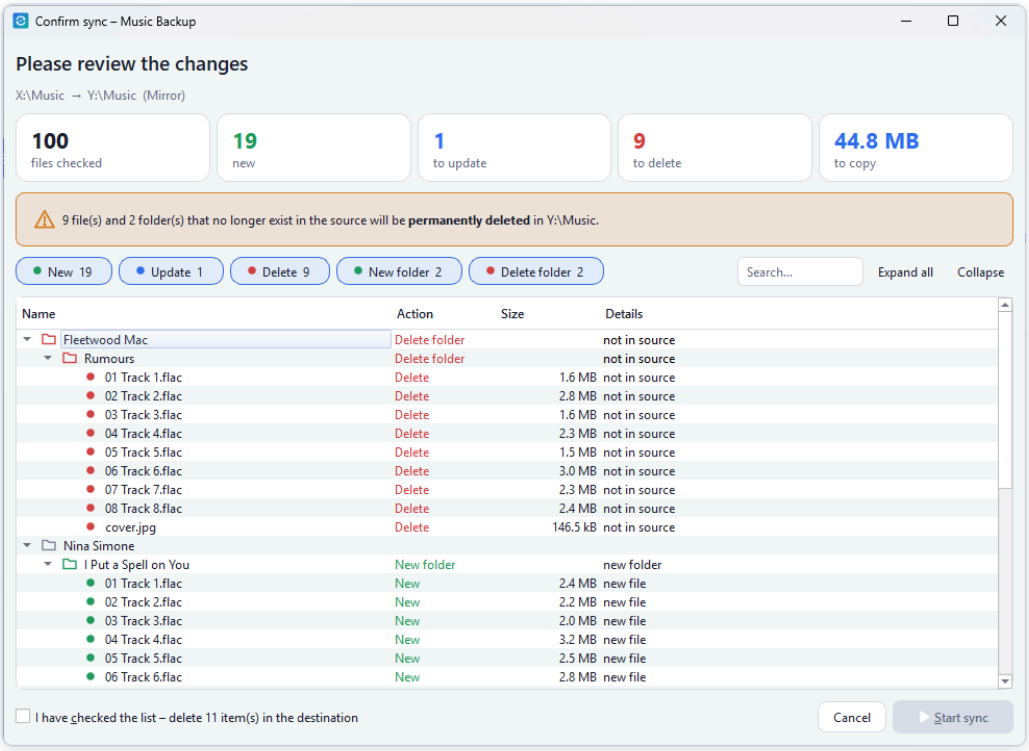
> **Tip:** If the preview says "*Everything is up to date*", there is nothing to do.

## 6.2 Starting the sync

Click **Start sync** (or press `F5`).

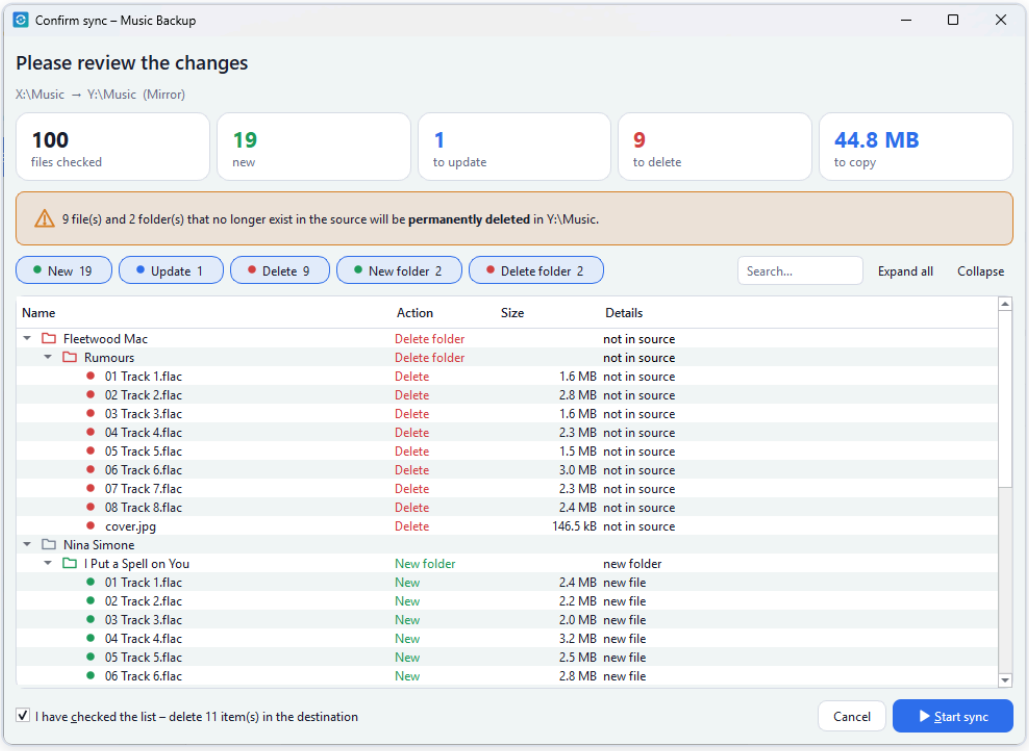
- In **Update** mode, or when nothing has to be deleted, the sync starts immediately.
- In **Mirror** mode with deletions, Oborcopy first shows the confirmation window.

## 6.3 Confirming a Mirror sync




This window looks like the preview. The orange box tells you **how many files and folders will be deleted** and **where**. The **Start sync** button stays grey until you tick the box at the bottom:

**☑ I have checked the list – delete 11 item(s) in the destination**

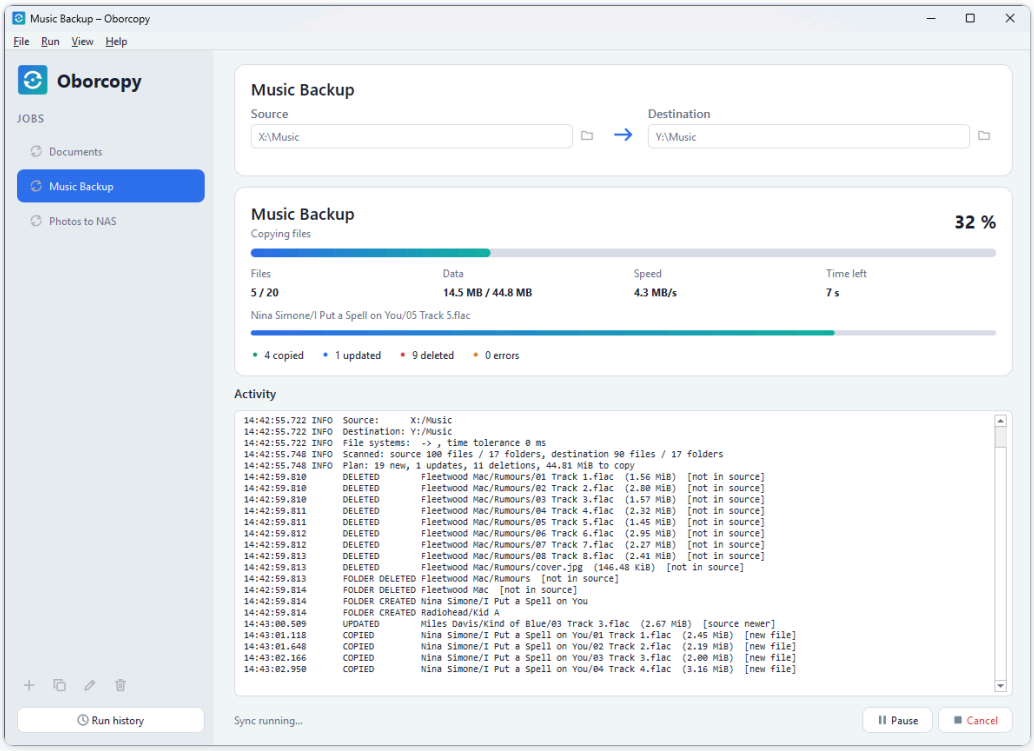



Then click **Start sync**.

> **Red warning?** If a large part of the backup would be deleted (more than 20 % by default), Oborcopy shows an additional **red warning**. This usually means that the **wrong source folder** was selected or that the **source disk is not connected**. Click **Cancel** and check the source first.

## 6.4 Watching the progress

While the sync is running, the options are replaced by the progress view:

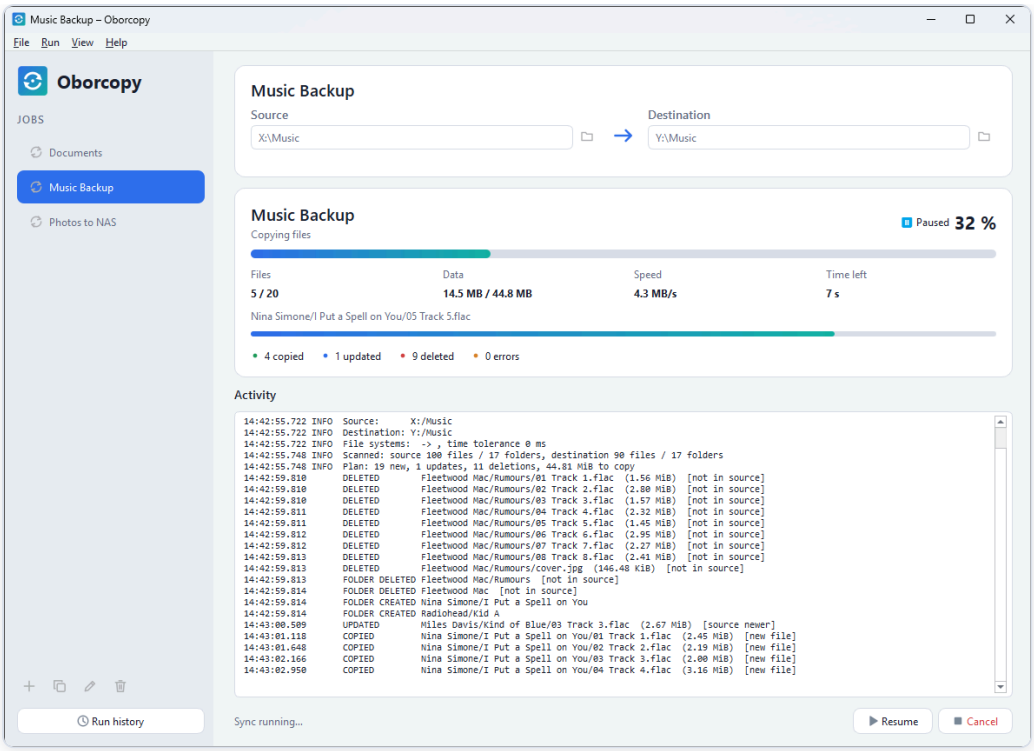



- **Percentage and bar** – overall progress (by amount of data).
- **Files** – files copied so far / files to copy.
- **Data**, **Speed**, **Time left** – amount copied, current speed and estimated remaining time.
- **Current file** with its own small progress bar.
- **Counters** – copied, updated, deleted, errors so far.
- **Activity** – a live list of everything Oborcopy does.

You can keep using your computer – Oborcopy stays responsive the whole time.

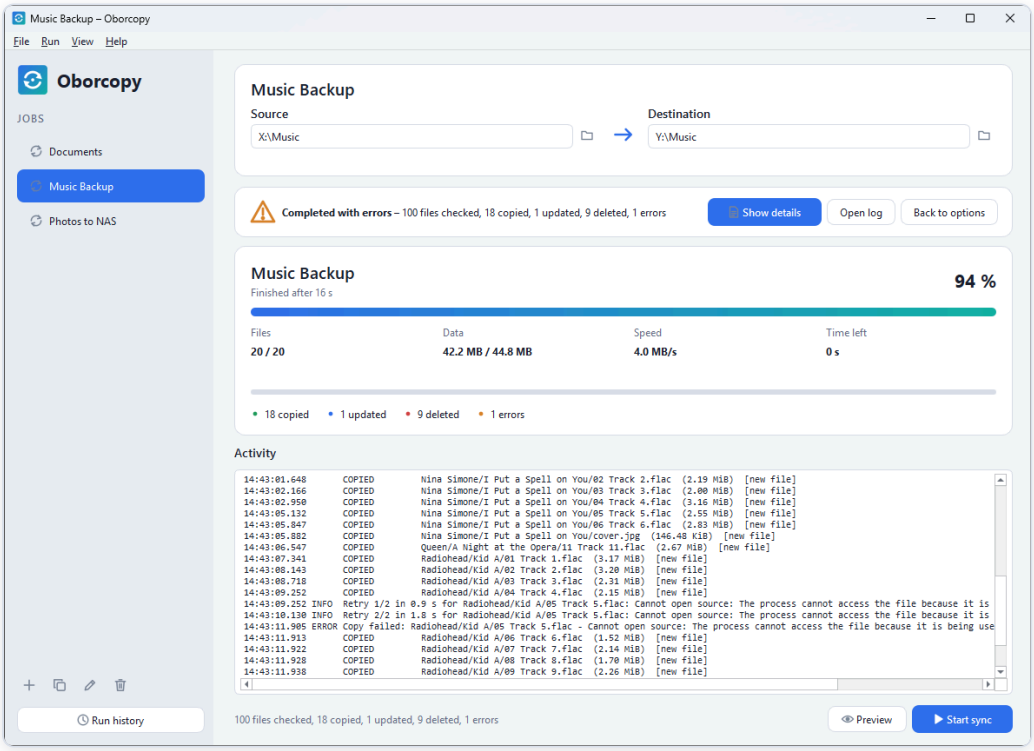
## 6.5 Pause, resume or cancel

- **Pause** ( `F7` ) – stops copying after the current block of data; the button changes to **Resume**. Useful if you need the full disk speed for something else for a moment.
- **Cancel** ( `Shift+F5` ) – stops the sync. Files already copied stay in the destination; the file that was being copied is discarded, so there are **never half-copied files** in your backup. Simply start the sync again later – Oborcopy continues where it stopped.




## 6.6 The result

When the sync is done, a result line appears at the top:




| Symbol | Meaning |
|---|---|
| Green check ✓ | **Completed** – everything worked. |
| Orange triangle ⚠ | **Completed with errors** – most files were copied, some could not be (see section 7.2). |
| Grey square ■ | **Cancelled** – you stopped the sync. |

| Symbol | Meaning |
| --- | --- |
| Red cross ✕ | **Failed** – the sync could not run (e.g. the source folder does not exist). The reason is shown. |

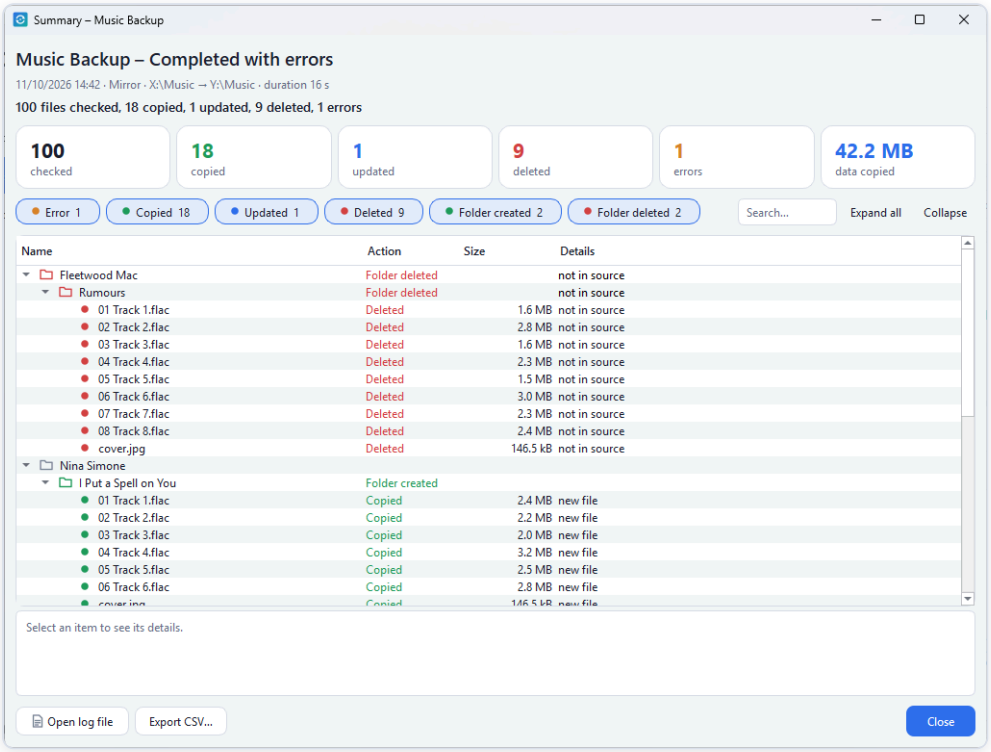
Buttons:

- **Show details** – opens the detailed summary (section 7).
- **Open log** – opens the log file of this run in a text editor.
- **Back to options** – returns to the job settings.

# 7. Reading the results

## 7.1 The detailed summary

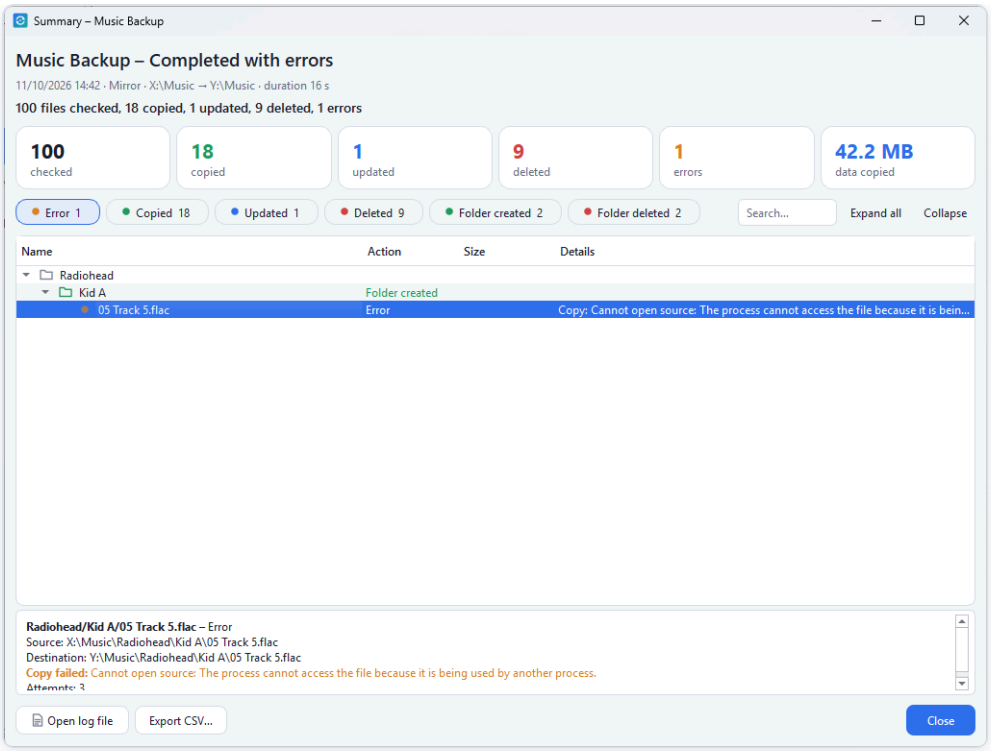
Click **Show details** after a sync, or open any earlier run from the **Run history**.




- **Top:** job name and result, date, mode, folders and duration, then the summary line, e.g. "*100 files checked, 18 copied, 1 updated, 9 deleted, 1 errors*".
- **Tiles:** checked, copied, updated, deleted, errors and amount of data copied.
- **Filter buttons:** *Error*, *Copied*, *Updated*, *Deleted*, *Folder created*, *Folder deleted* – click to show or hide each group.
- **Folder tree:** every file that was copied, updated or deleted, in its folder.
- **Details area (bottom):** click an entry to see the full source and destination path, size and reason.
- **Open log file** / **Export CSV...** – the CSV file opens in Excel or LibreOffice Calc.

## 7.2 Understanding errors

An error means that one file could not be processed – **all other files were still synced**. To see only the errors, switch off all filter buttons except **Error**, then click the file:




The details show what was attempted, the message from the operating system and how many attempts were made. In this example the file was **open in another program** ("being used by another process"); Oborcopy tried 3 times and then moved on.

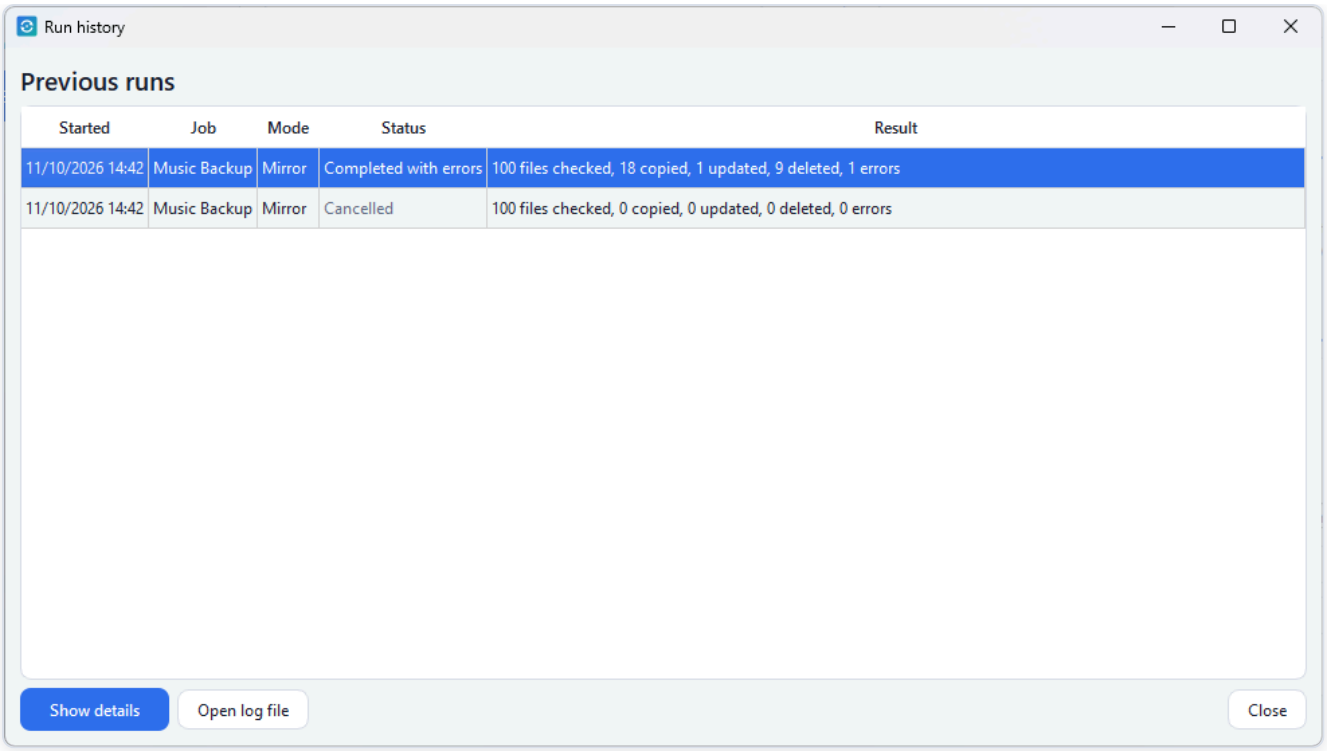
**What to do:** close the program that uses the file (or wait until it is finished) and simply run the sync again. Only the missing file will be copied.

Common messages:

| Message | Cause | Solution |
|---|---|---|
| *being used by another process* | The file is open in another program. | Close the program, run again. Increase *Locked files* retries if it happens often. |
| *Access is denied* / *Permission denied* | No permission to read the source or write the destination. | Check the folder permissions; on Windows, the file may be read-only on a protected location. |
| *Source file no longer exists* | The file was deleted or moved while the sync was running. | Nothing to do. |
| *No space left on device* / disk full | The destination disk is full. | Free space or use a bigger disk. The preview warns about this in advance. |

## 7.3 Run history

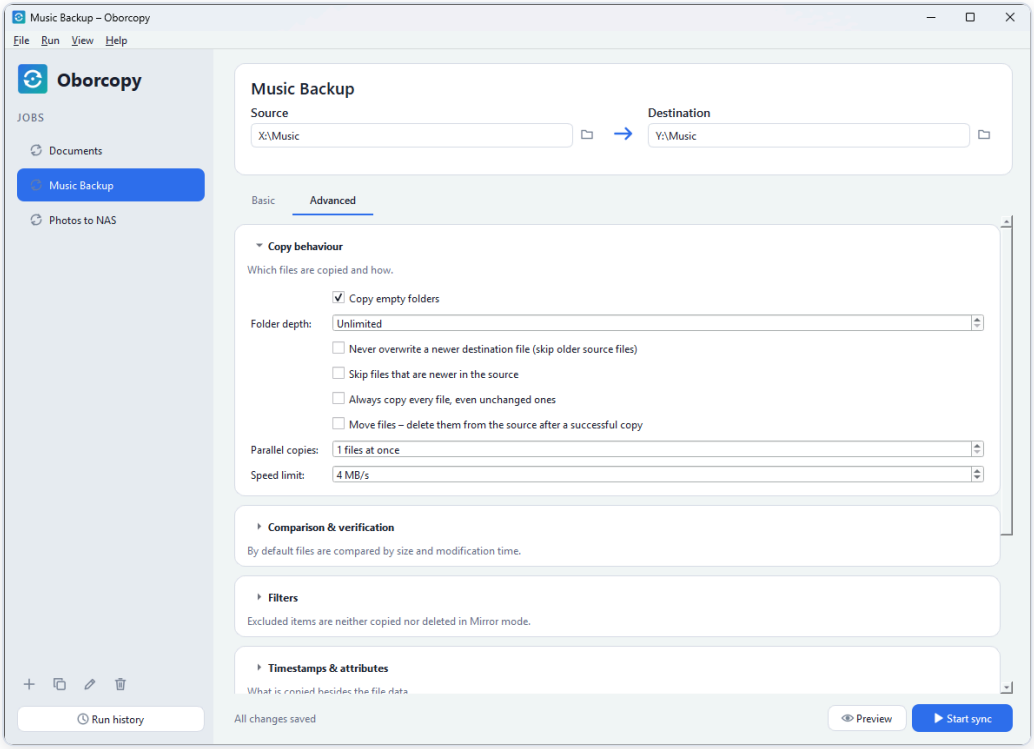
Click **Run history** in the sidebar (or *File* → *Run history…*, `Ctrl+H`) to see all earlier runs of all jobs:




Select a run and click **Show details** (or double-click it) to open its summary, or **Open log file** to read its log.

# 8. Advanced options

The **Advanced** tab contains the remaining options in sections. Click a section title to open or close it. The defaults are chosen so that you normally don't need to change anything here.




## 8.1 Copy behaviour

| Option | Meaning |
|---|---|
| **Copy empty folders** | Also create folders that contain no files. |
| **Folder depth** | *Unlimited*, or only the first *n* folder levels (1 = only the files directly in the source folder). |
| **Never overwrite a newer destination file** | If the file in the destination is newer than the source, keep it. |
| **Skip files that are newer in the source** | Only copy new files and files that became older (rarely needed). |
| **Always copy every file** | Copy everything, even unchanged files (slow – for special cases). |
| **Move files** | Delete each file from the **source** after it was copied successfully. ⚠ Use with care. |
| **Parallel copies** | Copy several files at the same time. Helpful for SSDs and network drives; for normal hard disks 1 is usually fastest. |
| **Speed limit** | Limit the copy speed in MB/s, e.g. to keep a network usable. *Unlimited* = full speed. (In the screenshot a limit of 4 MB/s is set.) |

## 8.2 Comparison & verification

| Option | Meaning |
|---|---|
| **Ignore exact 1-hour differences** | Prevents re-copying everything after the switch to/from daylight saving time on FAT disks. Turn on if you see all files being "updated" twice a year. |
| **Compare file contents (SHA-256)** | Also compares the actual contents of files that look unchanged. Finds silent changes, but reads every file – much slower. |
| **Verify every copied file** | After copying, the copy is read again and compared with the original. Recommended for very valuable data; takes about twice as long. |

## 8.3 Filters

| Option | Meaning |
|---|---|
| **Only files** | Copy only matching files, e.g. `*.mp3; *.flac`. Empty = all files. |
| **Minimum / Maximum size** | Skip files that are smaller / larger than the given size (MB). |
| **Skip files newer / older than** | Skip files by age in days. |
| **Skip hidden / system files** | Skip hidden files and folders, or Windows system files. |
| **Links** | Skip symbolic links and junctions (default) or follow them and copy their target. |

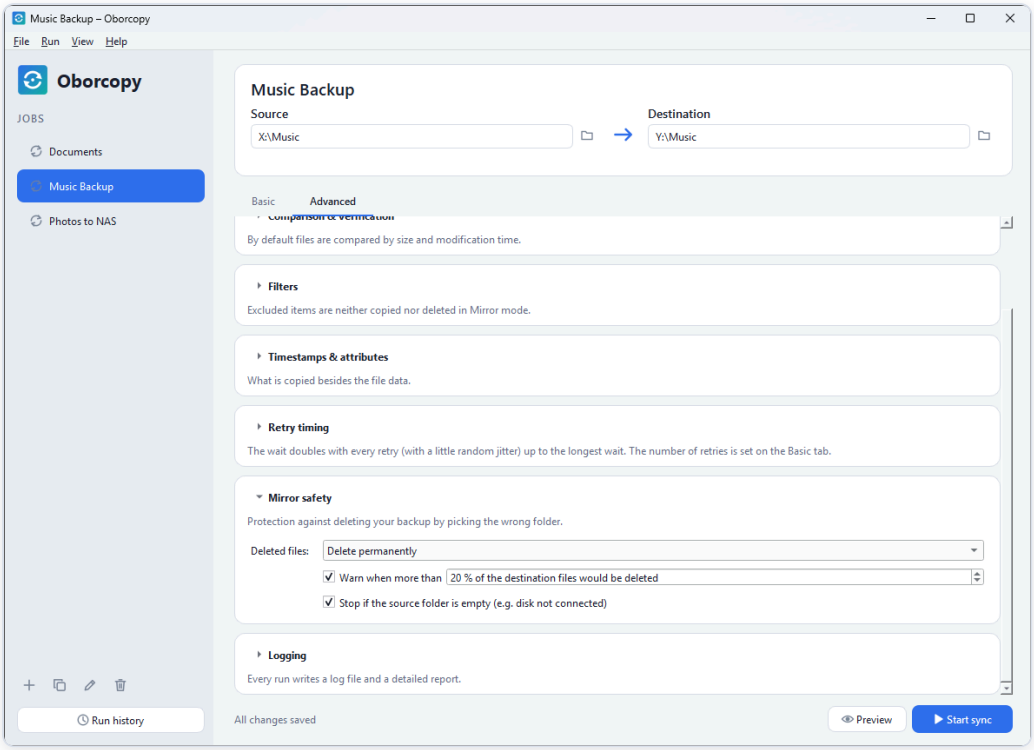
## 8.4 Timestamps & attributes

Keep **file modification times** switched on – Oborcopy needs them to recognise unchanged files next time. Folder times, Windows attributes (read-only, hidden …) and Linux permissions can also be kept.

## 8.5 Retry timing

**First wait** (default 2 s) and **Longest wait** (default 60 s) for locked files. The wait doubles with every attempt. The number of attempts is set on the Basic tab.

## 8.6 Mirror safety




| Option | Meaning |
|---|---|
| **Deleted files** | *Delete permanently* (default), or *Move to archive folder*: deleted files are moved into the folder `.oborcopy-archive` in the destination (sorted by date and time) instead of being deleted. You can restore them from there or delete the archive later yourself. |
| **Warn when more than … % … would be deleted** | Shows a red warning in the confirmation window (and stops automatic command-line runs) when many files would be deleted. Default 20 %. |
| **Stop if the source folder is empty** | Prevents wiping your backup when the source disk is not connected. Keep it on. |

## 8.7 Logging

| Option | Meaning |
|---|---|
| **Log folder** | Where log files are stored. Empty = default location (section 11). |
| **Detail** | *Summary only*, *Changes* (every copied/updated/deleted file – recommended) or *All files* (also unchanged files – large logs). |
| **Keep logs of the last** | Older logs of this job are deleted automatically (default: 50 runs). |

# 9. Weekly backups – the recommended routine

For a music collection (or photos, documents …) with one backup disk:

**Once – set up the job**

1. Create a job, e.g. *Music Backup*.
2. Source = your music folder, Destination = a folder on the backup disk.
3. Choose **Mirror**.
4. *Optional:* Advanced → Mirror safety → **Move to archive folder** for extra safety.

**Every week**

1. Connect the backup disk.
2. Start Oborcopy, select the job.
3. Click **Start sync**.
4. If files will be deleted, look at the list in the confirmation window. Are these really files you removed on purpose? Then tick the box and click **Start sync**.
5. Check the result line. If it shows errors, open **Show details**.
6. Safely remove ("eject") the backup disk.

> **Tip:** Keep a second backup disk at another place (e.g. at work or with family) and create a second job for it with **Duplicate**.

# 10. Automatic backups

Oborcopy can run your jobs automatically at set times – every few hours, daily, weekly or monthly. The easiest way is the built-in **Oborcopy Scheduler** service (10.1 – 10.5). If you prefer, you can still use the command-line tool with the Windows Task Scheduler or cron (10.6 – 10.8).

## 10.1 The Oborcopy Scheduler service

The Oborcopy Scheduler is a small background program that is installed as a real service of your operating system:

- **Windows:** it appears in *Services* ( `services.msc` ) as **Oborcopy Scheduler** and starts automatically with Windows.
- **Linux:** it is a *systemd user service* ( `oborcopy.service` ) of your account. Check it with `systemctl --user status oborcopy` .

The service runs **under your own user account**. That is why it sees the same jobs, the same folders and the same network shares (e.g. `\\nas\backup` ) as Oborcopy itself. You can **close Oborcopy** – the service keeps running and starts your jobs on time. Oborcopy is only the *Service Manager*: you use it to set up, control and check the service.

The service runs one job at a time with `oborcopy-cli` and writes the normal log file and run report – so every automatic run appears in the **Run history**.

## 10.2 Installing the service

1. Open *Service → Service Manager…* ( `Ctrl+M` ) or click the **status pill** in the sidebar above *Run history*.
2. Click **Install service…**.
3. **Windows:** confirm the administrator question (UAC). Windows then asks for **your Windows password** – the service needs it to log on as you. Use your password, not a Windows Hello PIN. Oborcopy never sees or stores the password; Windows keeps it. **Linux:** nothing to confirm – no root password is needed. Oborcopy also enables *linger*, so the service keeps running after you log out and starts at boot. If your system does not allow that, Oborcopy shows a note; the service then runs while you are logged in.
4. The status changes to **Service running**.

> **Tip:** If you change your Windows password later, the service can no longer log on. The Service Manager then shows an error – click **Update password…**.

## 10.3 Scheduling a job

1. In the Service Manager click **Schedule a job…** – or select a job in the main window and choose *Service → Schedule this job…*.
2. Choose the **job** and how often it should run:
   - **Every few hours** – e.g. every 4 hours at minute :15 (00:15, 04:15, 08:15 …)
   - **Daily** – at a time, e.g. 23:30
   - **Weekly** – on the days you tick, e.g. Mon and Thu at 07:00
   - **Monthly** – on a day of the month, or on the **last day**. A day the month does not have (e.g. 31) runs on its last day.
3. Options:
   - **Run a missed backup once after start-up** – if the computer was off at the scheduled time, the job runs once when the service starts again.

    - **Allow deletions in Mirror mode** – needed for unattended Mirror jobs. The *Mirror safety* threshold (8.6) still applies: if too many files would be deleted, the run stops instead.
4. The preview at the bottom shows the next run times. Click **Save schedule**.

Scheduled jobs show a **clock icon** in the job list. Changes are picked up by the running service within a few seconds. Untick **On** in the list to switch a schedule off without deleting it.

## 10.4 Controlling the service

| Button | What it does |
|---|---|
| **Start** | Starts the stopped service. |
| **Pause / Resume** | While paused, no scheduled job starts. A job that is already running finishes. |
| **Stop** | Stops the service. A running job is cancelled cleanly (it shows as *Cancelled* in the history). |
| **Restart** | Stop + Start. |
| **Uninstall** | Removes the service. Your schedule is kept for a later installation. |

The **status pill** in the sidebar always shows what the service is doing:

| Pill | Meaning |
|---|---|
| **Service running** · *Next: Music Backup · today 23:30* | Waiting for the next job (the dot pulses gently). |
| **Backing up: Music Backup** | A scheduled job is running right now (faster pulse). |
| **Service paused** | No job starts until you resume. |
| **Service stopped** / **Scheduler not set up** | Scheduled jobs do not run. |
| **Service error** | Click it to see the reason, e.g. a changed Windows password. |

If you move the Oborcopy folder or unpack a new version somewhere else, the Service Manager tells you that the service still uses the old folder – click **Use this Oborcopy**.

> **Before deleting the Oborcopy folder,** uninstall the service in the Service Manager.

## 10.5 Checking scheduled runs

- The Service Manager lists every scheduled job with its **next run**, **last run** and **result**. **Last run details** opens the detailed summary of the last run.
- **Scheduled run history** opens the Run history filtered to runs started by the scheduler. There you can use **Show details** and **Open log file** as usual. In the normal Run history, the column *Started by* shows **Scheduler** or **You**.
- **Service log** opens the service's own log (start, stop, schedule changes, every run).
- If you start a job in Oborcopy while the service is running the same job, Oborcopy warns you first.

## 10.6 The command-line tool

Besides the window program, Oborcopy includes the command-line tool `oborcopy-cli`. It runs a saved job without a window – useful for scripts or your own scheduler.

Example: `oborcopy-cli --job "Music Backup" --yes` runs the job *Music Backup* and allows deletions.

| Option | Meaning |
|---|---|
| `--list-jobs` | Show all saved jobs. |
| `--job "Name"` | Run the saved job with this name. |
| `--job-file file.json` | Run a job from a JSON file. |
| `--dry-run` | Only show what would happen. |
| `--yes` | Allow deletions in Mirror mode. **Without it, a Mirror run with deletions is stopped** – a safety measure. |
| `--force` | Run even if the "too many deletions" warning applies. |
| `--quiet` / `--verbose` | Less / more output. |
| `--help` | Show all options. |

When it finishes, `oborcopy-cli` returns a **result code**: 0 = nothing to do, 1 = files copied, 2 = files deleted, 3 = both, 8 = some files failed, 16 = the run could not be done or was stopped.

## 10.7 Windows: weekly backup with the Task Scheduler

1. Press the **Windows key**, type **Task Scheduler** and open it.
2. Click **Create Basic Task...** on the right.
3. Name: *Oborcopy Music Backup* → **Next**.
4. Trigger: **Weekly** → **Next** → choose the day and time (e.g. Sunday 20:00) → **Next**.
5. Action: **Start a program** → **Next**.
6. *Program/script:* browse to `oborcopy-cli.exe` (e.g. `C:\Tools\Oborcopy\oborcopy-cli.exe`). *Add arguments:* `--job "Music Backup" --yes --quiet` *Start in:* the Oborcopy folder (e.g. `C:\Tools\Oborcopy`) → **Next** → **Finish**.

Make sure the backup disk is connected at that time. Each automatic run appears in Oborcopy's **Run history** with its full summary.

## 10.8 Linux: weekly backup with cron

Open the cron table with `crontab -e` and add this line (Sunday 20:00 – use the path where you unpacked Oborcopy):

```
0 20 * * 0  /opt/oborcopy/oborcopy-cli --job "Music Backup" --yes --quiet
```

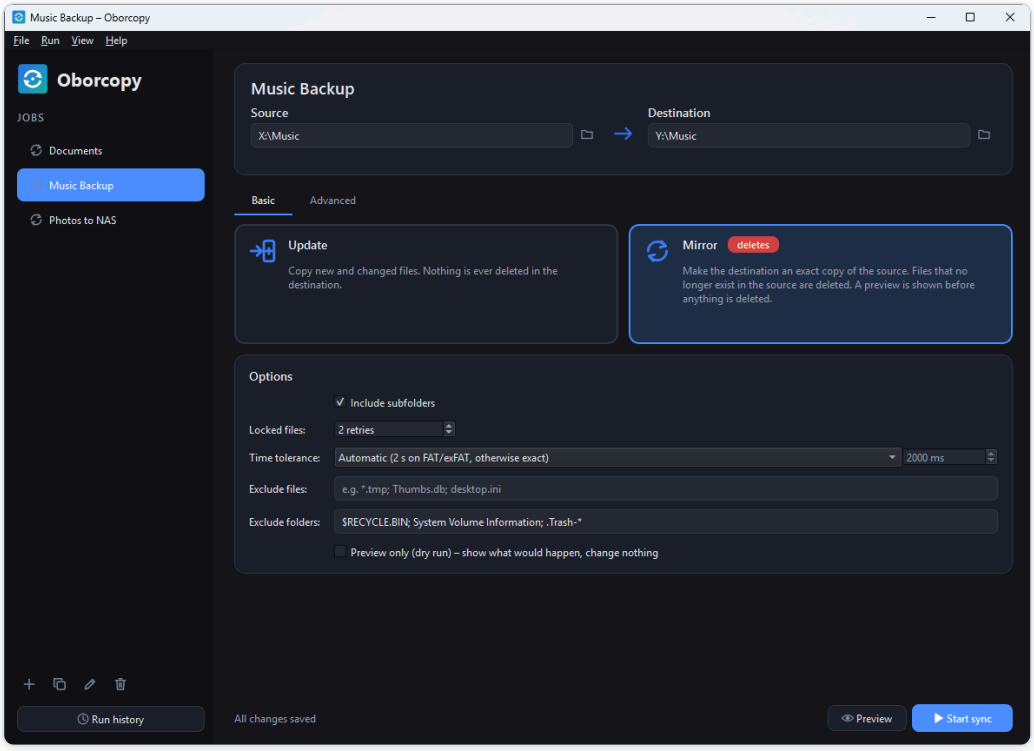
# 11. Settings, log files and where things are stored

| What | Windows | Linux |
|---|---|---|
| Jobs | `%LOCALAPPDATA%\Oborcopy\jobs\` | `~/.config/Oborcopy/jobs/` |
| Program settings (theme, window size) | `%LOCALAPPDATA%\Oborcopy\settings.json` | `~/.config/Oborcopy/settings.json` |
| Log files and run reports | `%LOCALAPPDATA%\Oborcopy\logs\` | `~/.local/share/Oborcopy/logs/` |
| Scheduler: schedule, status and service log | `%LOCALAPPDATA%\Oborcopy\service\` | `~/.config/Oborcopy/service/` |
| Scheduler service definition | Windows *Services* ( `Oborcopy` ) | `~/.config/systemd/user/oborcopy.service` |

- *File → Open log folder* opens the log folder directly.
- Each run writes a readable `.log` file and a `.json` report (used for the Run history).
- To **back up or move your jobs** to another computer, copy the `jobs` folder.
- **Portable use:** if the environment variable `OBORCOPY_CONFIG_DIR` points to a folder (e.g. on a USB stick), Oborcopy stores everything there.

## 11.1 Light and dark theme

Choose *View → Theme → System, Light* or *Dark*. *System* follows the setting of your operating system.



# 12. How Oborcopy protects your data

Oborcopy is designed so that a mistake does not destroy your backup:

1. **Look before you act** – everything is compared first; nothing is changed before you start the sync.
2. **Confirmation of deletions** – Mirror mode shows every file that will be deleted and requires your confirmation.
3. **Too-many-deletions warning** – a red warning when an unusually large part of the backup would be deleted.
4. **Empty source protection** – if the source folder is empty (e.g. disk not connected), the sync is stopped.
5. **Folder check** – the destination may not be the same as the source or lie inside it.
6. **No half-copied files** – each file is first written under a temporary name and only renamed when it is complete. Even a power failure leaves no broken files behind.
7. **Archive instead of delete** – optionally, deleted files are kept in `.oborcopy-archive`.
8. **Retries** – files that are briefly in use are tried again automatically.
9. **Logs** – every run is documented.

# 13. Questions and troubleshooting

**The first sync takes long – is that normal?** Yes. The first run copies everything. Later runs only copy changes and are much faster.

**Every sync copies all files again. Why?**

- Check Advanced → *Timestamps & attributes* → **Keep file modification times** is on.
- Keep *Time tolerance* on **Automatic** (needed for FAT/exFAT disks).
- If it happens after the clock change in spring/autumn, turn on **Ignore exact 1-hour differences** (Advanced → Comparison).

**Oborcopy says "The source folder is empty but the destination is not".** The source disk is probably not connected or the wrong folder is selected. This protection prevents your backup from being wiped. Check the source folder.

**How do I restore files from my backup?** The backup is a normal folder with normal files – simply copy the files back with Explorer / your file manager. Or create a job with the backup as source and your original location as destination (use **Update** mode to be safe).

**Can I use network drives or a NAS?** Yes – choose the network folder like any other folder (e.g. `\\nas\backup` on Windows or a mounted share on Linux). *Parallel copies* (Advanced) can make network copies faster.

**I renamed a file only in upper/lower case (e.g. `song.mp3` → `Song.mp3`).** On Windows this is not treated as a change; the file is not copied again.

**Can I keep using the computer during a sync?** Yes. Use **Pause** if you need the full disk speed for a moment.

**Linux: "could not load the Qt platform plugin xcb".** Install the basic graphics libraries of your distribution, e.g. on Ubuntu: `sudo apt install libgl1 libegl1 libxkbcommon-x11-0 libfontconfig1`

**Where do I find out what happened in an automatic run?** Open Oborcopy → **Run history** (column *Started by* = **Scheduler**), or the Service Manager → **Last run details** / **Service log**.

**A scheduled backup did not run.** Check the status pill: the service must be **running** and not paused, and the schedule must be switched **On**. Was the computer off or asleep? Then the job runs after start-up only if *Run a missed backup once after start-up* is ticked. Was the backup disk connected? The **Service log** shows every start and its result.

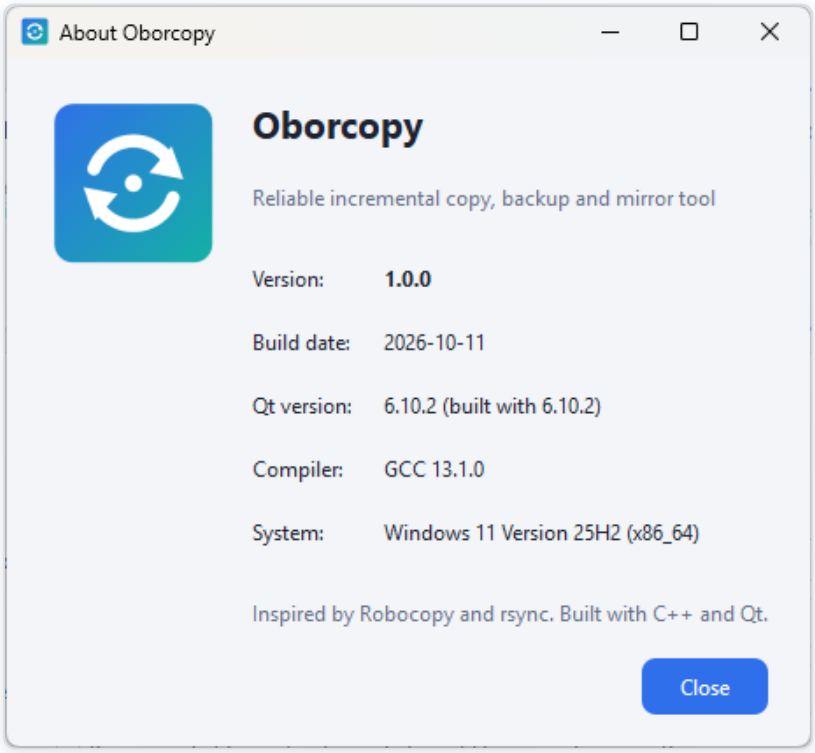
**The Service Manager shows "Windows could not log on the service".** Your Windows password has changed. Click **Update password…** and enter the new password.

# 14. Keyboard shortcuts and version

| Key | Action |
|---|---|
| `F5` | Start sync |
| `F6` | Preview |
| `F7` | Pause / Resume |
| `Shift+F5` | Cancel the running sync |
| `Ctrl+N` | New job |
| `Ctrl+S` | Save job (also happens automatically) |
| `Ctrl+H` | Run history |
| `Ctrl+M` | Service Manager (scheduled backups) |
| `Alt+F4` | Exit (Windows; on Linux also `Ctrl+Q`) |
| `Alt+C`, `Alt+S` | In the confirmation window: tick the check box, start the sync |

## 14.1 Version information

*Help → About Oborcopy* shows the version, the build date and technical details – please include them when you report a problem.



# 15. Glossary

| Term | Explanation |
|---|---|
| **Source** | The folder that is backed up. Oborcopy only reads from it (except with *Move files*). |
| **Destination** | The folder that receives the copy. |
| **Job** | Saved settings for one backup task. |
| **Update mode** | Copies new and changed files; never deletes. |
| **Mirror mode** | Makes the destination identical to the source, including deletions. |
| **Preview / Dry run** | Shows what would happen without changing anything. |
| **Extra file** | A file that exists in the destination but not (anymore) in the source. |
| **FAT / exFAT** | File systems used by USB sticks and many external disks; they store file times in 2-second steps. |
| **Time tolerance** | How much file times may differ and still count as equal. |
| **Archive folder** | `.oborcopy-archive` in the destination – receives deleted files if this option is on. |
| **Oborcopy Scheduler** | The background service that runs your jobs at set times, also when Oborcopy is closed. |
| **Log file** | Text file with everything that happened during a run. |